NGUYEN QUYNH HUONG

PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION

NSW PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION DASHBOARD

Introduction

Transport for NSW is always the busiest topic among society well-being, and also the top contributor to the success of the NSW economy. Transportation in NSW was established first in November 2021.

Executive Summary

01
PUBLIC TRANSPORT PATRONAGE

has not fully recovered post-COVID-19, showing slow growth compared to pre-pandemic levels despite affordability improvements in real fare terms.

02
AFFORDABILITY AND CONVENIENCE

remain central to recovery, with the Opal fare system continuing to influence travel decisions and accessibility across NSW.

03
CUSTOMER SATISFACTION

highlights clear performance gaps, particularly in train reliability and safety, while buses and ferries perform strongly in service quality.

Insight analysis

01. ANNUAL PATRONAGE

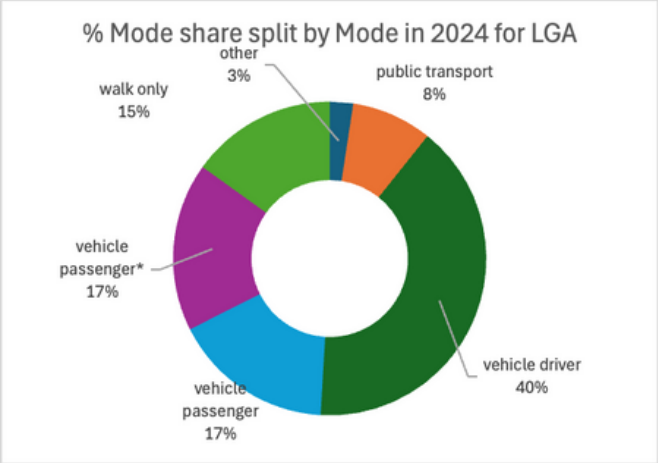
- The Opal card rollout (Dec 2016) encouraged sustained growth in recorded trips due to convenience and digital tracking.
- COVID-19 caused a severe drop in patronage during lockdowns, with recovery remaining partial through 2024–2025.
- Bus and train continue to dominate mode share, while light rail and metro show gradual uptake and ferry trips decline.

Recomendation

Fare management remains critical — moderate fare increases should continue to align with inflation trends to avoid deterring ridership while maintaining network funding stability.

02. FARE AFFORDABILITY TRENDS

- Nominal Opal fares increased from $5.16 (2021) to $6.05 (2024) — creating perceived cost pressure among riders.
- However, when adjusted for inflation, real fares are lower than 2021 levels, indicating that fare policy has effectively maintained affordability.
- This balance between nominal increases and real-term affordability plays a key role in sustaining ridership recovery.



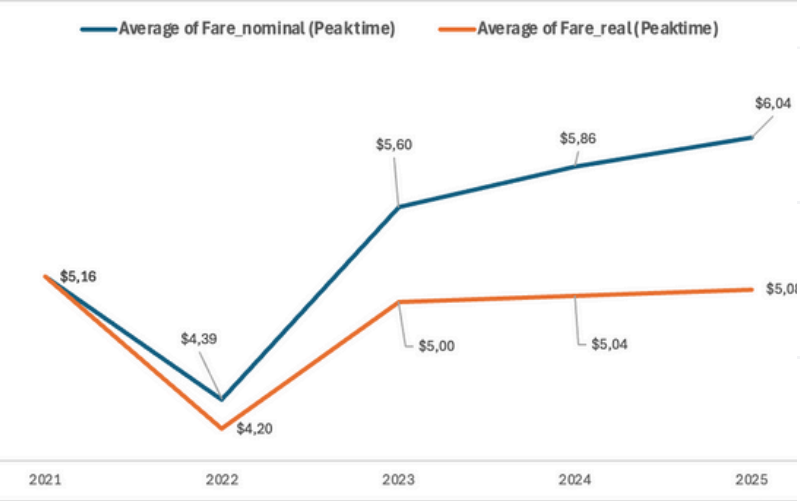


Figure 2.1: share mode and affodability

0.3 POST-COVID MODE SHARE SHIFT

- Work-from-home adoption and hybrid work schedules have permanently reduced weekday commuting frequency.
- Private vehicle usage now accounts for ~60% of all trips, while public transport share fell to 6–7%.
- Walking and local travel increased, reflecting proximity-based mobility choices and ongoing health concerns.

Recomendation

- ***Bring it more public transportation improvement suggesting focus on convenience, hygiene, and flexibility outweighed shared-mobility advantages.***
- ***The core service of timeliness (real-time updates, fewer cancellations), and integration with greener, on-demand options.***
- ***Rebuilding customer confidence through safety and security will be key to reversing pandemic-driven car dependence and supporting NSW's long-term mobility goals (mentioned bellow in part 4).***

0.4 CUSTOMER SATISFACTION AND SERVICE QUALITY

- Ferries and buses ***achieved high Customer Satisfaction Index (CSI) scores (~97%)***, driven by strong perceptions of safety and punctuality.
- Train services ***scored notably lower on reliability (0.48)***, service frequency, and connection efficiency, indicating ongoing issues with punctuality, timetable gaps, and poor multimodal coordination. Passengers face long waits, missed transfers, and limited first-mile access, reducing confidence in public transport.

Recomendation

Prioritise reliability improvements (more resilient train scheduling and maintenance), increased service frequency on high-demand routes, and better timetable integration between bus, train, and ferry networks.

Conclusion

While affordability in real terms remains stable, ridership recovery lags due to shifting commuter behaviour and reliability challenges.By focusing on customer trust, operational reliability, and affordability messaging, Transport for NSW can accelerate the return to public transport and align with NSW's 2030 sustainable mobility goals.

Data source

- ***2021 Census: method of travel to work***
- ***TfNSW open Data Hub.***
- ***Maximum Opal fares 2025-2028, IPART NSW.***
- ***Ilearn***